

Experiment No. 2

Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

1. Aim

To create a Zoho Creator account, develop a sample application, create forms, reports, and dashboards, and explore the platform architecture and interface, including the Develop, Deploy, and Manage modules.

2. Setting Up Zoho Creator

Step 1: Create a Zoho Creator Account

1. Open the Zoho Creator website.
2. Sign up using an email address or Google account.
3. Verify the email address and log in.
4. Access the Zoho Creator dashboard.

Step 2: Create a Sample Application

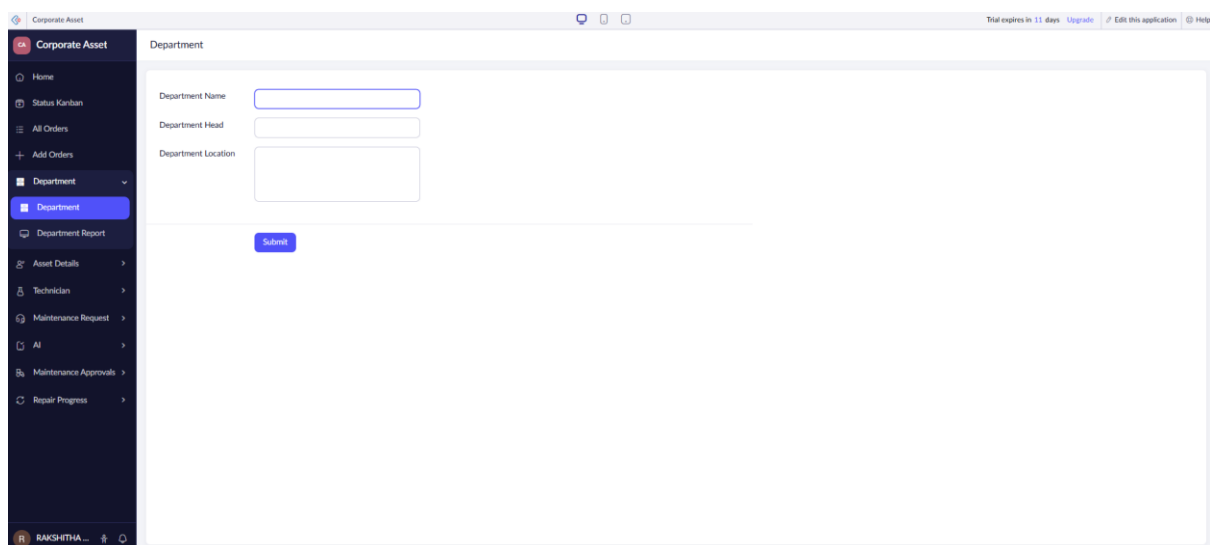
1. Click Create New Application.
2. Select Blank Application.
3. Enter the application name.
4. Click Create to generate the application.

I) Sample Application

A sample application Corporate Asset is created to understand the features and functionalities of Zoho Creator. The application contains forms for collecting data, reports for viewing stored records, and dashboards for visualizing important information. This helps users learn how to build and manage applications using the low-code platform.

II) Creating Form, Report, and Dashboard

A. Creating a Form



The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator interface for a sample application named 'Corporate Asset'. On the left, a dark sidebar contains a navigation menu with options: Home, Status Kanban, All Orders, Add Orders, Department (selected), Department Report, Asset Details, Technician, Maintenance Request, AI, Maintenance Approvals, and Repair Progress. The main workspace shows a form titled 'Department' with three input fields: 'Department Name', 'Department Head', and 'Department Location'. A blue 'Submit' button is positioned below the 'Department Location' field. The top of the interface includes a header bar with the application name 'Corporate Asset', a user profile icon, and a trial status indicator: 'Trial expires in 11 days' with links to 'Upgrade', 'Edit this application', and 'Help'.

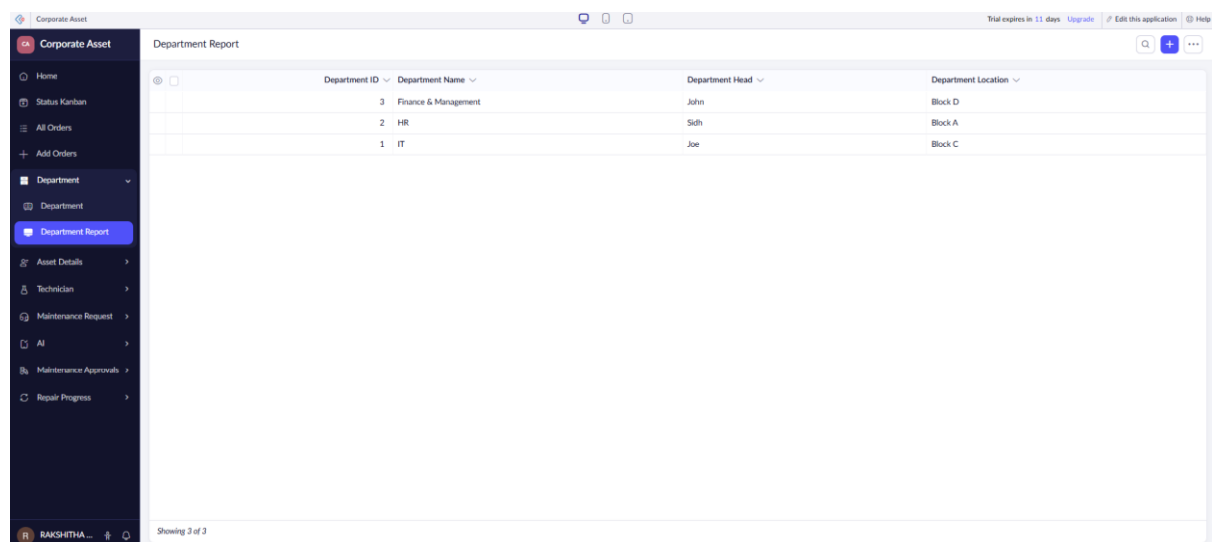
Explanation:

A form is the primary component used to collect information from users in a Zoho Creator application. It acts as the interface through which users enter and submit data. Forms can contain different types of fields such as Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Email, Phone Number, Lookup, Dropdown, Checkbox, Radio Button, and File Upload.

To create a form, click Create → Form, provide a form name, and add the required fields using the drag-and-drop interface. The properties of each field, such as field name, data type, mandatory status, default value, and validation rules, can be configured. Once the form is created, it is saved and becomes ready to accept user input.

Forms help in collecting accurate and organized data. They also support field validation, automatic calculations, and workflow automation, making data entry simple and efficient.

B. Creating a Report



Department ID	Department Name	Department Head	Department Location
3	Finance & Management	John	Block D
2	HR	Sidh	Block A
1	IT	Joe	Block C

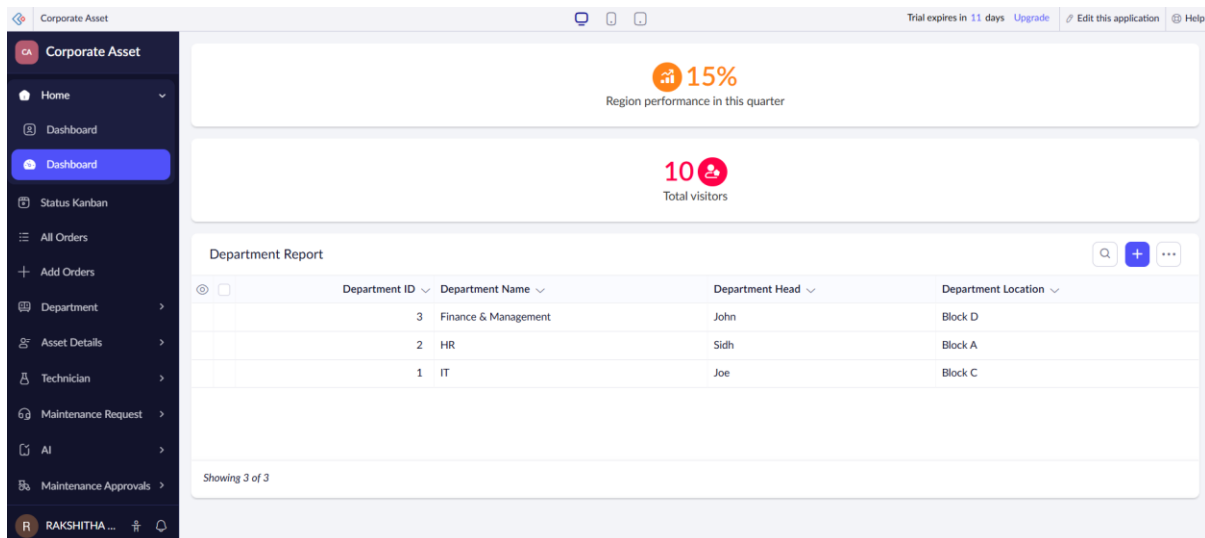
Explanation:

A report is used to display and manage the records stored in a form. After users submit data through a form, the entered information is automatically stored and can be viewed using reports.

To create a report, select Create → Report, choose the corresponding form, and select the report type such as List Report, Summary Report, Calendar Report, Kanban Report, or Spreadsheet Report. Reports can be customized by selecting the fields to display, applying filters, sorting records, grouping data, and adding search options.

Reports make it easier to view, search, edit, update, or delete records. They also help users analyze stored information efficiently and generate meaningful insights from the collected data.

C. Creating a Dashboard



Explanation:

A dashboard is a visual interface that displays important information from the application in the form of charts, tables, widgets, and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs). It provides a quick overview of the application's data without requiring users to open individual reports.

To create a dashboard, select Create → Dashboard, give it a name, and add components such as charts, reports, gauges, stat widgets, buttons, embedded pages, and HTML snippets. These components can be arranged and resized according to the required layout.

Dashboards help users monitor application performance, track important statistics, and make better decisions by presenting data in a clear and interactive manner. They improve the overall user experience by providing a centralized view of important information.

3. Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

A. Develop

- The Develop section is the main workspace where applications are designed and built in Zoho Creator. It provides a visual development environment that allows users to create forms, reports, pages, dashboards, workflows, and schedules using drag-and-drop components.
- Developers can configure field properties, create relationships between forms, write Deluge scripts for advanced functionality, automate business processes, and integrate the application with external services. The Develop module simplifies application creation while reducing the need for extensive manual coding.

B. Deploy

- The Deploy section is responsible for making the completed application available to users. Once development is completed and tested, the application can be deployed for use on web browsers and mobile devices.
- This module allows developers to configure user permissions, share the application with specific users or organizations, publish updates, and distribute new versions whenever modifications are made. The deployment process ensures that users always access the latest version of the application with minimal effort.

C. Manage

- The Manage section is used to administer and maintain the application after deployment. It provides tools for managing users, assigning roles and permissions, monitoring application usage, configuring security settings, and maintaining application performance.
- Administrators can manage backups, restore data if required, configure integrations, monitor storage usage, and track user activities. The Manage module helps keep the application secure, reliable, and properly maintained throughout its lifecycle.

Result

Thus, a Zoho Creator account was successfully set up, and a sample application was created. Forms, reports, and a dashboard were developed to understand the basic features of the platform. The Develop, Deploy, and Manage modules were explored, and the architecture and interface of Zoho Creator were studied. This experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator enables rapid application development using a low-code approach with minimal programming effort.